

YOUR BABY'S REFLEXES

Newborn babies have reflexes that form part of their survival skills. In addition to the rooting and grasping reflexes shown here, babies also have a startle reflex, whereby they will fling out their arms if unsupported, and a stepping reflex, which means they will step their feet up and down if held upright on a surface.



Rooting reflex: If you touch or stroke your baby's cheek, they will turn toward that side with their mouth open in search of food.



Grasping reflex: If you place your finger in the palm of your baby's hand, they will instinctively tightly grip your finger.